

Colored lips

- **What?** Twist-up lipstick
- **Who?** James Bruce Mason, Jr.
- **Where and when?** US, 1922

People have painted their lips since ancient times, but this was usually done with a brush. In the early 20th century, someone came up with the idea of putting solid lipstick in a sliding metal container. This was soon followed by the twist-up tube, a device that continues to be used today.



Illustration of a woman applying lipstick, 1930

Dry shaving

- **What?** Electric razor
- **Who?** Jacob Schick
- **Where and when?** US, 1928

In 1928, Colonel Jacob Schick of the US Army used the money he made from an earlier successful invention—a razor that stored blades in its handle—to come up with the first electrically powered dry shaver. Later innovations include the introduction of a protective foil covering over the blades by the British company Remington in 1937, and the development of the rotary blade shaver by the Dutch company Philips in 1939.



Grooved body of this battery-powered razor made it easy to hold.

Schick Electric Shaver, c.1934



Hair spray

- **What?** Aerosol spray can
- **Who?** Erik Rotheim
- **Where and when?** Norway, 1927

The Norwegian chemical engineer Erik Rotheim's invention—the aerosol can—didn't really catch on at first. It wasn't until World War II that it was adapted by the American chemist Lyle Goodhue

into a device for dispensing insect repellent known as a "bug bomb" for US troops. People noticed the spray can's potential and, after the war, aerosol technology was adapted for a range of domestic uses, including for hair spray, as seen above in this 1955 advertisement.

Sunscreen

- **What?** Ambre Solaire
- **Who?** Eugène Schueller
- **Where and when?** France, 1936

The French chemist Eugène Schueller's oil, Ambre Solaire, was the first mass-market sunscreen to protect skin against harmful ultraviolet (UV) radiation that can cause skin cancer. It was produced in the 1930s when sunbathing became popular in the south of France. The lotion was also used to protect soldiers from sunburn in World War II.

